

# Team Working Agreement

**Course:** COMP4350 – Software Engineering 2

**Project Name:** The Story Machine

**Team Name:** Beluga

**Date Created:** September 25, 2026

## Team Members

| Name | Program / Year (optional) | Preferred Name / Pronouns (optional) |
|------|---------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| 1    | Computer Science / 4th    | Lara De Leon                         |
| 2    | Computer Science / 4th    | Arthur McMullen                      |
| 3    | Computer Science / 4th    | Carsten Kolynchuk                    |
| 4    | Computer Science / 4th    | Colin Leger                          |
| 5    | Computer Science / 4th    | Oluwanifemi Tawoju                   |
| 6    | Computer Science / 4th    | Krupal Patel                         |
| 7    | Computer Science / 4th    | Adejare Taiwo                        |

---

## 1. Shared Team Goals (can add more than 3)

As a team, we agree that our shared goals for this project are:

- Produce a polished, high quality final product that we are proud of
- Start work early so that we can maintain a low stress environment
- Learn and apply unfamiliar technologies
- Distribute our work fairly to ensure that all group members can contribute meaningfully
- Maintain clear communication throughout the project

---

## 2. Individual Goals

Each team member lists their personal goals for this project.

| Team Member     | Individual Goals                                                                                                                                                                  |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Lara De Leon    | Gain experience working with technologies I haven't used before, improve my understanding of system design, gain experience working on a large and collaborative software project |
| Arthur McMullen | Learn new technologies, work with different database systems, make good decisions around architecture, and most importantly, be proud of what I make.                             |

|                    |                                                                                                                                                                      |
|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Carsten Kolynchuk  | Gain experience working in a larger group, learn more about large project architecture, and be satisfied with the final product.                                     |
| Colin Leger        | Learn and become familiar with the technologies we are using, be a dependable and productive teammate and gain experience working with a team on a software project. |
| Oluwanifemi Tawoju | Work on new technologies. Gain experience working in a larger group. Building a project from scratch to full release.                                                |
| Krupal Patel       | Learn as much as possible on the new technologies, write good code, be an effective and reliable member to the team.                                                 |
| Adejare Taiwo      | Gain experience working on a large team, building software from the ground up. Become more familiar with unfamiliar technologies                                     |

---

### 3. Roles and Responsibilities

Roles may rotate unless otherwise specified. Note: none of these are developer roles. You are all responsible for development as well and these are just recommended additional roles to define.

| Role                | Description                                   | Assigned To       |
|---------------------|-----------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Project Coordinator | Organizes meetings, tracks deadlines          | Arthur McMullen   |
| Technical Lead      | Oversees technical decisions and code quality | Adejare Taiwo     |
| Documentation Lead  | Maintains README/docs                         | Lara De Leon      |
| GitLab Manager      | Manages repo structure, merges, issues        | Carsten Kolynchuk |
| Quality Checker     | Reviews work before submission                | Colin Leger       |

*If responsibilities are shared or rotated, describe how below:*

We have agreed that these responsibilities will be shared across the entire group and will rotate throughout the project as needed. Role assignments may be adjusted based on a group member's workload, availability, and project requirements so we can ensure responsibilities are distributed fairly and there isn't a single group member that is overburdened.

---

### 4. Communication Plan

**Primary communication channel(s):** Discord

**Expected response time:**

- Weekdays: 24 hours
- Weekends: 48 hours
- During critical deadlines: 3 hours

**When is escalation required?**

(e.g., no response after 24–48 hours, missed meeting, blocked progress)

- No response to group communications after our agreed upon response period (listed above)
- Missing a scheduled meeting without notifying the group in advance
- Not completing assigned tasks by agreed upon deadlines without communicating delays

---

## 5. Meetings

**Regular meeting time(s):** Meet at least once a week, with a goal of meeting twice per week

**Meeting platform/location:** Virtual (Discord), though in person meetings might be arranged if it is more convenient for the group

**Meeting norms:**

- Start/End Times
  - Meetings should start at the scheduled time, but end times are flexible and may be extended as needed to complete discussions
- Cameras are not required to be on during group meetings
- Meeting notes will be shared in a channel on Discord
- All group members are expected to contribute to discussion and project discussions

**What happens if someone cannot attend?**

Ideally, a group member should notify the rest of the group as soon as possible if they cannot attend a meeting. Meeting notes and decisions will be documented and shared in our Discord channel so any absent members can stay informed.

If a group member does not attend and has not provided notice, the group will attempt to contact them during or shortly after the meeting. Any repeated unexcused absences may be addressed through our group's conflict resolution process.

---

## 6. Work Expectations

- How tasks will be assigned (e.g., issues, task board): GitHub Issues. Group members can volunteer for tasks or tasks can also be assigned during meetings to ensure that the work is distributed fairly.
- Definition of “done” for a task:
  - The required functionality has been implemented and works as intended

- Any documentation has been updated (i.e., GitHub issue updated and marked as completed)
  - Another group member has reviewed or verified the work before it is merged or submitted
- Expectations around code quality / documentation:
  - Code should be readable and follow our agreed upon coding standards
  - Include meaningful comments
  - Significant changes should be documented when appropriate
  - Group members are expected to follow and contribute to our documentation standards
  - Our chosen Git branching strategy is **GitHub Flow**

---

## 7. Conflict Resolution & Unmet Expectations

If conflict arises or expectations are not met, we agree to follow this process **in order**:

1. Resolve the issue within the group. We will try to discuss the concern directly and give all involved parties an opportunity to explain their perspective.
2. As a group, work toward a mutually acceptable solution and identify misunderstandings or areas where we disagree.
3. If the issue can't be resolved internally, consult Lauren for guidance.
4. If a group member intends to provide a negative peer evaluation, they should first discuss the concern with the individual involved and give them an opportunity to address the issue.

### How will concerns be raised respectfully?

We will raise concerns directly and respectfully, with the goal of resolving the issue rather than assigning blame. All group members will be given an opportunity to share their perspective and we will address concerns as early as possible.

---

## 8. Responsible GenAI Use

As a team, we have discussed the responsible and ethical use of Generative AI tools (e.g., ChatGPT, Copilot) for this project. We agree on the following shared norms:

Allowed uses of GenAI in this project include:

- Generating boilerplate or template code
- Assisting with code reviews
- Generating diagrams
- Assisting in development of test strategies. Any AI-generated test code needs to be received by multiple team members before use

Disallowed uses of GenAI in this project include:

- Generating substantial portions of our project code
- Making architectural or system design decisions
- Art

Key risks we have identified related to GenAI use (e.g., correctness, over-reliance, fairness, integrity):

- Over-reliance instead of developing our own understanding
- Generating poor quality code

How our team will ensure transparency, accountability, and shared understanding of AI-assisted work:

- Group members will disclose any AI use
- Any group member is responsible for understanding and being able to explain any AI assisted work they contribute
- Our group will follow an honour system and raise concerns if AI use appears inconsistent with these guidelines

---

## 9. Accountability

If a team member repeatedly misses deadlines or responsibilities, the team will:

- Meet with the individual to discuss the issue and identify any challenges preventing them from contributing
- Reassign any urgent work as necessary to ensure that the project's progress is not blocked
- Document that group member's missed responsibilities and reflect the lack of contribution in our peer reviews
- If the issue continues, we will notify Lauren and provide her with a summary of the steps we've already taken to resolve the situation
- As compensation for creating additional work for the team, the offending group member owes everyone lunch

---

## 10. Agreement

By signing below, we confirm that we have discussed this document together and agree to follow it.

| Name              | Signature    | Date               |
|-------------------|--------------|--------------------|
| Lara De Leon      | Lara De Leon | September 30, 2026 |
| Carsten Kolynchuk | CK           | September 30, 2026 |
| Colin Leger       | CL           | September 30, 2026 |

|                    |                 |                    |
|--------------------|-----------------|--------------------|
| Arthur McMullen    | Arthur McMullen | September 30, 2026 |
| Krupal Patel       | KP              | September 30, 2026 |
| Oluwanifemi Tawoju | OT              | September 30, 2026 |
| Taiwo Adejare      | TA              | September 30, 2026 |